

## Rigaku Holdings (268A)

2Q results: Strong semiconductor-related inquiries, full-scale sales contribution expected from 4Q

**Neutral:** 2Q operating profit was ¥1.9 billion (–32% YoY; Bloomberg estimate ¥3 billion, our estimate ¥4 billion), and management maintained full-year guidance at ¥19.4 billion (+16% YoY; ¥19.6 billion, ¥18.2 billion). Multipurpose analytical instruments business recovery is somewhat delayed, affected by budget cuts in US academia, but the company expects full-year sales to surpass guidance (weighted toward 4Q) on strong demand for semiconductor process control instruments. Management has taken a cautious approach to profits, based mainly on material costs, forex, and upfront investment, but is pushing forward steps to improve earnings, including revising prices.

- **2Q results summary:** 2Q sales were ¥21.6 billion (+7% YoY, +21% QoQ) and operating profit ¥1.9 billion (–32% YoY, +3x QoQ). Operating profit by segment was as follows: (1) Multipurpose analytical instruments ¥300 million (–78% YoY, ¥200 million loss in 1Q). Business for US academia continued to face headwinds, but Rigaku shifted from academia to industry and orders recovered to +6% YoY. (2) Semiconductor process control instruments were ¥1.4 billion (+69% YoY, +2.8x QoQ), with significant growth for memory and for logic. (3) Components & services segment ¥600 million (–61% YoY, –40% QoQ). Services performed solidly, supported by factors including price hikes, but components and other analytical instruments (such as multilayer mirrors for EUV) were weak, with business weighted toward 2H.
- **Outlook:** FY2026 guidance is unchanged at sales of ¥101 billion (+7% YoY) and operating profit of ¥19.4 billion (+16% YoY). Sales appear likely to beat guidance, but management is apparently not optimistic about operating profit, focusing on how far the rollout of new products and other initiatives can make up for worsening gross profit (sharply higher material costs, forex impact, upfront investment). 1H operating profit reached 13% of full-year guidance, while the company also expects 3Q to be in line with 2Q, but it expects results will again be weighted toward 4Q in FY2026. However, inquiries remain strong for semiconductor products, and Rigaku has already received most orders for FY2026, providing reassurance. Its outlook by segment is as follows. (1) Sales recovery is delayed in multipurpose analytical instruments, running behind full-year guidance. However, orders bottomed in 2Q, and management expects growth of over 50% YoY in 3Q. (2) Management thinks the semiconductor process control instruments segment is likely to top full-year guidance, led by demand associated with increased memory production and supported by recovery in North American IDMs and progress in new joint evaluation program (JEP) products. JEP projects tend to provide a leading indicator, and there were 14 of these at end-1H (14 over FY2025) while management expects to accumulate more in 2H, raising expectations for earnings in FY2027 onwards. (3) There were no material changes from initial expectations in components & services.

## Overweight

268A.T, 268A JP  
Price (07 Aug 26): ¥2,171  
Price Target (Dec-26): ¥3,100

### Japan Equity Research

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## Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

### Rigaku Holdings (268A) (Overweight; Price Target: ¥3,100)

#### Investment Thesis

As semiconductor structures become more complex (e.g., miniaturization and multilayering), there are cases in which it is difficult to conduct inspection and measurement with conventional optical/CD measurement. Demand for X-ray testing will likely increase, given that the complexity of semiconductors is expected to increase further in the future. We expect Rigaku, which already has a significant presence and a strong track record, to achieve growth in excess of that of the market as a whole.

#### Valuation

We base our December 2026 price target of ¥3,100 on our FY2026 estimates, using a sum-of-the-parts approach, and an EV/EBITDA reflecting a 10% conglomerate discount.

#### Sum-of-the-parts model based on FY2026 estimates

| FY12/26E (¥mn unless otherwise noted)      | EBITDA | EV/EBITDA |       | EV   | Per share<br>(JPY) |       |
|--------------------------------------------|--------|-----------|-------|------|--------------------|-------|
|                                            |        | OP        | D&A   |      |                    |       |
| Multipurpose Analytical Instruments        | 8,000  | 5,100     | 2,900 | 14.0 | 112,000            | 495   |
| Semiconductor Process Control Instruments  | 13,200 | 10,500    | 2,700 | 45.0 | 594,000            | 2,624 |
| Components and Services                    | 5,900  | 5,300     | 600   | 14.0 | 82,600             | 365   |
| Corporates                                 | -2,700 | -2,700    | 0     | 14.0 | -37,800            | -167  |
| Sub-total                                  | 24,400 | 18,200    | 6,200 |      | 750,800            | 328   |
| Net debt                                   |        |           |       |      | 25,403             | 112   |
| Total                                      |        |           |       |      | 776,000            | 3,428 |
| Number of shares outstanding ('000 shares) |        |           |       |      | 226,383            |       |
| Theoretical value (JPY)                    |        |           |       |      | 3,428              |       |
| Discount                                   |        |           |       |      | -10%               |       |
| Theoretical price (JPY)                    |        |           |       |      | 3,100              |       |

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.

#### Risks to Rating and Price Target

##### Upside Scenario to Target Price/Rating

- Increasing penetration of X-ray equipment, including XRD, in the semiconductor market
- Advancement of schedule for semiconductor complexity and miniaturization
- Increase in demand due to semiconductor market conditions entering an upcycle
- Delay in advances in optical/CD measurement technology

##### Downside Scenario to Target Price/Rating

- Reduction in the attractiveness of X-ray measurement due to dramatic evolution of optical/CD measurement technology
- Delay in schedule for semiconductor complexity and miniaturization
- Decline in demand due to a downcycle in the semiconductor market
- Delay in startup of new plant
- Slow x-ray throughput improvement

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Rigaku Holdings (268A) (268A.T, 268A JP) Price Chart



| Date      | Rating | Price (Y) | Price Target (Y) |
|-----------|--------|-----------|------------------|
| 27-Nov-24 | OW     | 1158      | 1,400            |
| 26-May-25 | OW     | 722       | 1,200            |
| 21-Jan-26 | OW     | 1211      | 1,400            |
| 16-Mar-26 | OW     | 1903      | 2,200            |
| 22-May-26 | NR     | 2375      | --               |
| 17-Jun-26 | OW     | 2555      | 3,100            |

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.  
Initiated coverage Nov 27, 2024. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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